S5 course 6_25_26_Students

We use conditional sentences to say one thing depends on another. They can be used to talk about real or imaginary situations. One of the clauses starts with *if* (or a similar word) – this is the conditional clause. The other clause talks about the result of the conditional clause happening.

Let's look at some examples.

If you don't tell *me,* ***I'll*** *just* ***keep*** *asking.*
If I promise *to travel less,* ***will you forgive*** *me?*

I know that one. It's a first conditional: *if* + present simple, then *will* + infinitive.

It's for talking about a situation in the future which the speaker thinks is quite possible. If the first condition happens, something will happen as a result. In this conditional sentence, the present tense after *if* refers to the future, not the present.

And can we change the order of the clauses round?

Yes, and we leave out the comma in the middle of the sentence if the order is changed round.

I'll *just* ***keep*** *asking* ***if you don't tell*** *me.*

I also know the second conditional. *If* + past simple, then *would* + infinitive.

This is for talking about an unlikely or unreal condition.

If you travelled *less because of me,* ***I'd feel*** *worse.*
If I had *the opportunity to visit places like that,* ***I wouldn't complain****!*

So, in the second example, Oliver doesn't think he will have the opportunity to travel a lot. It's possible but improbable. We use the past simple to show that it's not likely, not to indicate past time.

Can we use any other verbs, apart from *would*, in this kind of conditional?

Yes, we sometimes use other modal verbs like *might* or *could* in the result clause (not the *if* clause).

What about, 'If you mix blue and yellow, you get green'. Is that a conditional?

Yes. That's a zero conditional. We often use them for facts, or in academic subjects.

> ***When it rains** a lot, **the animals move** to higher ground. (geography)*

What about other words that can replace *if*, like *unless* and *as long as*?

Well, *unless* is a kind of negative version of *if*.

> *I'll never go **unless** you take me. (= If you don't take me, I'll never go.)*

As long as imposes a condition on someone. You're telling them what you expect them to do.

> *You can borrow my surfboard **as long as** you get it back to me by five o'clock.*

So if you agree to what I say, you can borrow my surfboard?

Are there any other conditionals?

There's the third conditional, but we'll deal with that separately.

Phew! Now, *if you don't mind, I'll have* to stop there.

I- Conditionals

Write one word to fill each gap.

1. If I enough money, I'd buy a car.

2. If I to Dan's party, I'll call you.

3. I sleep better if I didn't have to share a room.

4. you call me when you get there?

5. If I have too much homework to do this weekend, I'll come out with you.

6. I'd really bored without my phone!

7. If you regular exercise, you'll feel a lot better.

8. You don't need to call me unless you a problem.

II- Conditionals

Choose the correct verb form to complete the conditional sentences.

1. If the bus is late, I _____ late for school.

   'll be 'd be was

2. I'll phone Charlie from home later if I _____.

remembered remember 'll remember

3. If I go to the shops this afternoon, I _____ some chocolate for you.

buy 'll buy would buy

4. If I _____ enough money, you know I'd lend it to you.

have would had

5. I _____ borrow my parents' car if I had my driving licence.

can could 'll

6. I _____ tell anyone if you tell me.

wouldn't won't not

7. If there's any cake left I _____ another piece.

had would have 'll have

8. If you had three wishes, what _____ you wish for?

did would will

ANSWERS

I- Conditionals

1. If I (had/earned/saved) enough money, I'd buy a car.

2. If I (go) to Dan's party, I'll call you.

3. I (would/ ;d / could / might) sleep better if I didn't have to share a room.

4. (Will / can) you call me when you get there?

5. If I (don't / do not) have too much homework to do this weekend, I'll come out with you.

6. I'd (be / feel / get) really bored without my phone!

7. If you (do / take / get) regular exercise, you'll feel a lot better.

8. You don't need to call me unless you (have / notice / see/ experience / find) a problem.

II- Conditionals

1. 'll be
2. remember
3. 'll buy
4. had
5. could
6. won't
7. 'll have
8. would